going to cause very grave concerns in the Indian government, Parliament and elsewhere. He wanted to know the truth.

Goheen told Mehta that he had received a message from the state department, informing him that an article on the subject had appeared in a radical left magazine which was a successor or sister magazine to Rolling Stone. 'The state department are looking into the matter and will let the Ambassador know as soon as they have ascertained the truth,' Goheen replied sheepishly.

Mehta, however, emphasised that if the allegation happened to be true, it was imperative that Indians should know as soon as possible what the hazards were. 'If it is to be assumed that no leakage of radioactivity has yet taken place, we must know what the dangers are of future leakage and what can be done to provide safety against such a danger. Meanwhile, there is bound to be a great deal of alarm all over the country,' Mehta told Goheen.

After the meeting, Mehta wrote a letter to IB chief S.N. Mathur, asking him to provide details of the involvement of Indian agents. He sent copies to the R&AW chief, the PMO and the home secretary. He believed that the IB's vault might have documents dating back to 1966.

'In view of the extremely sensitive and indeed explosive nature of the allegations made in the article, I would be grateful if you could ascertain whatever details are possible, including the alleged involvement of our own Intelligence agencies in the affair,' Mehta wrote.

There was no reply from the IB. But the government believed the report and wanted to know from the Indian